

Oppo F33 Pro

Big on style, mixed on substance

Oppo has been on a strong run lately. The brand has had a stellar array of recent launches, including the Find X9s and the mighty Find X9 Ultra. But it's not just the flagship phones; Oppo has built a strong lineup across various price segments, be it in the form of the premium mid-range Reno series or the budget-focused K-series. Having said that, one gap that still remains is the upper mid-range segment, that tricky Rs 35,000-40,000 range where buyers expect top-tier premium smartphone experience without the flagship price.

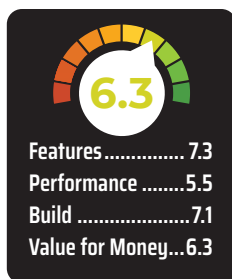
To tackle this, the Oppo F33 Pro is the brand's answer. It sits just above the K-series and just below the Reno 15 series. It's a phone I've used as my daily driver for a good while, and after all that time, I can tell you exactly who it is for. I don't want to sound poetic, but it's a device that looks and feels like much more than it does. But then there's the hardware, which tells a slightly different story.

DESIGN AND BUILD

When it comes to the looks, build, and design, the F33 Pro does not disappoint. Without a shadow of a doubt, it is one of the best-looking phones at this price. It features what Oppo likes to call the 'Starry Sea' lens module on the back, which is a fancy way of saying: there's a rectangular camera island, housing the camera and a ring flash, and it gives the phone a distinctive look.

Oppo sent me the Misty Forest variant for testing, and, among all the other colour options, it has to be my favourite. It features a subtle gradient that catches the light beautifully, and, rather than the simple back design

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most phones use, it feels unique. I will also admit that the design has been a bit of a head-turner.

Coming in at just 194 grams, the F33 Pro feels relatively compact and well-balanced for a phone carrying a 7,000mAh battery. Where Oppo has really gone above and beyond, though, is durability. The phone carries IP66, IP68, IP69, and IP69K certifications, in addition to the MIL-STD-810H military-grade shock resistance.

Overall, with the Oppo F33 Pro, you not only get the good looks but also a phone that has reassuring build quality.

DISPLAY AND SPEAKERS

Moving over to the front of the phone, the Oppo F33 Pro gets a 'not so big, but not so small' 6.57-inch FHD+ AMOLED panel with a 120Hz refresh rate. Compared to the other phones in the

price range where larger displays are becoming more common, I much prefer the relatively compact footprint of this device. For my hand, it fits in perfectly for one-handed usage. Visually too, the display is sharp and fluid, and Oppo has done a good job with the tuning, making anything on the screen pop in a way that most buyers will notice.

On our lux meter, the F33 Pro hit a brightness of 1,840 nits, which is much higher than Oppo's official 1,400 nits claim in High Brightness Mode. What you need to know is that the display is quite bright to be comfortably readable even under harsh summer sun. Moving over to our Calman analysis, again, you don't get disappointed by the numbers, as the colour gamut coverage came in at an impressive 99.1 per cent.

Though the average Delta E of 3.6 in the colour checker analysis is a bit lower than expected. For the most part, it's acceptable for this segment, but if you were to put it in side-by-side comparisons with other devices, chances are it might fall a bit short. For most users, though, the display will simply look great.

Personally, I had a lot of fun watching both YouTube videos and OTT content on the Oppo F33 Pro, and a major reason behind it was the excellent speakers. Just like other Oppo phones, the F33 Pro features a 300 per cent volume boost mode, which makes the sound much louder. The audio feels clear, and for the price range, it is well on par with other devices.

PERFORMANCE AND SOFTWARE

Now, the performance is where I felt like the mid-range pricing starts to show itself. Internally, the phone comes powered by the MediaTek Dimensity 6360 Max, which is a 6 nm chip capable of handling everyday tasks like browsing, social media and casual video streaming without any major hiccups. But again, if you're buying a phone, at this price